

TEACHING TIPS:

- In your warm-up, **focus on breathing** to help sustain the lyrical melody in this song.
- The chorus should be positive and punchy, sung with lots of energy. Be sure to separate and emphasize important lyrics such as 'God is good to us' so they can be heard. Contrast this in the verses with a **legato** sound and use good breath control to make sure the long C (on 'change' in verse 1) is held for its full four beats.
- As the melody goes quite low in the register in the chorus (on 'You are faithful God'/'We are grateful Lord'), be careful not to let these words die away too much – good breath support is important here.

WHAT YOU NEED

Tuned instruments e.g. glockenspiels (pre-prepared to include only the notes C D E G A); note cards or black/white board

LISTEN

Drones are used in all genres of music, including medieval, classical, popular and folk music. Try listening to the opening of John Adams's *Shaker Loops 1* or some Scottish bagpipe music, in which a low drone is always clearly heard.

STEP IT UP!

Using the letter names, see if the children can write out their melodies on strips of paper. Encourage them to add other details like **tempo** – is it fast, slow or something in between? Write this at the beginning of the 'score' – and **dynamics** (*ff*, *f*, *mf*, *mp*, *p*, *pp*). Some children might be able to try using standard music notation to write out the notes of their melodies.

DYNAMICS

Volume

TEMPO

The speed of the music

Notation

Improvise

Sing

Listen

Play

Compose

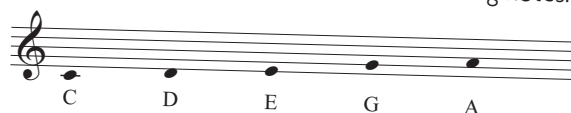
Genre/History/Musicians

ACTIVITY

AGES 7-11 

If you listen really carefully to the chorus you might notice that it mainly has the same bass note in the piano – B^b – and only briefly strays to other nearby notes. This is called a **tonic** (the first note of the scale), **pedal note** or **root note** and reinforces the key of the song (B^b major). It can often be used as a **drone** which plays continuously beneath a melody. Using pitched percussion instruments or keyboards and working in pairs, ask the class to **compose their own simple melodies over a drone in the bass**.

To do this, use a **pentatonic scale** starting on C. Give the children the notes C D E G A to choose from (write the note names and standard notation on cards or on the board) and remind them to use short and long notes.



It will sound best if the melody starts and finishes on C (the tonic of this scale). One pupil plays the melody while their partner plays the C drone. Then swap over.

WHAT'S ACHIEVABLE?

- To compose a short pentatonic melody above a drone.
- To begin to use standard notation to record a composition.
- To sing a song with harmony parts.

PITCH

Tonic – the first note of a major or minor scale

Drone – a continuous musical note, often of low pitch

Pentatonic scale – a five-note scale pattern